

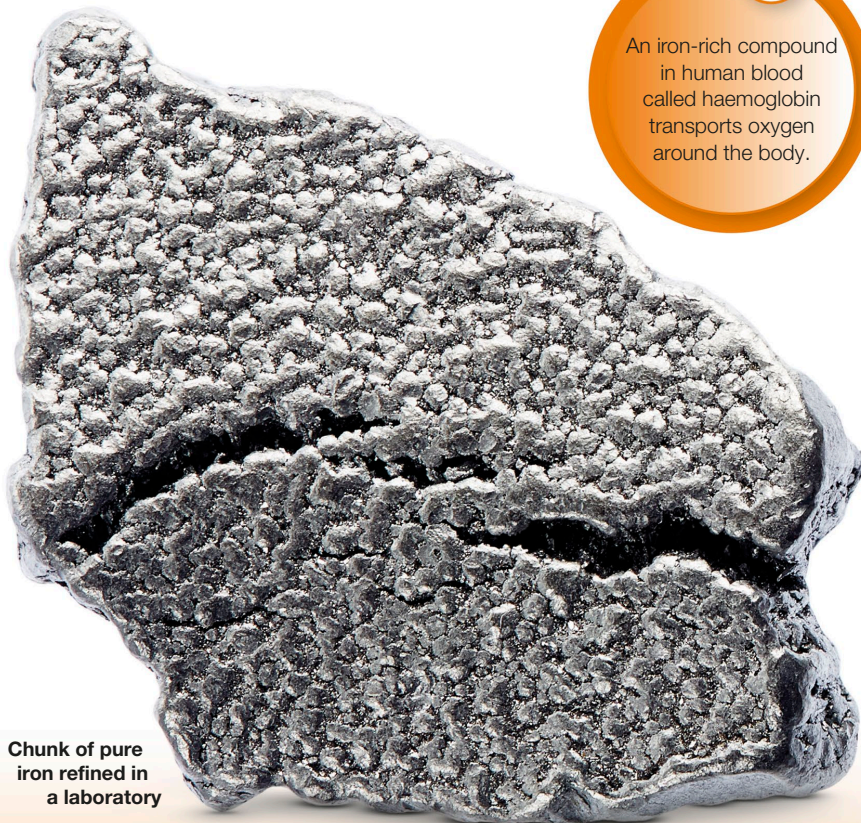
Iron

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Fe

Oxygen, silicon, and aluminium are more common than iron in rocks on Earth's surface, but it is iron that makes up around 35 per cent of Earth's mass. Most of it is found in the planet's core, which is a ball made of hot iron and nickel, nearly 5,000 km (3,100 miles) wide.

ATOMIC MASS 55.845**STATE** Solid**DISCOVERY** Around 3500 BCE

An iron-rich compound in human blood called haemoglobin transports oxygen around the body.



Chunk of pure iron refined in a laboratory